FOOD
TREND

vessel to carry other flavours such as jam, butter, cheese, or meats. But now, people are starting to appreciate bread for what it is. They are focussing on making the bread itself more delicious and satisfying. The goal is to enjoy the bread on its own, not just as a base for other ingredients. This shift means we are seeing a lot of creativity in bread-making. People are putting more thought into the flavour and texture of the bread itself, making it a more central part of the meal rather than just something on the side," says Hussain Shahzad, Executive Chef, Hunger Inc. Hospitality. For many, the renewed interest in sourdough is also health-related. There also seems to be some evidence that sourdough is easier to digest than typical white bread, and the yeasts and bacteria that help the bread rise are also beneficial for the gut, feeding into the current fixation with gut health.

### Bread artists

Today, artisanal bread has become something of an obsession for chefs and restaurateurs around the world. So much so that some bakeries are even commissioning, mixing and sometimes even milling their own flours to create the perfect loaf, pursuing the concept of terroir.

At the internationally acclaimed San Francisco based Tartine bakery, Chad Robertson is making bread with freshly milled flour that is not stripped of its nutrients. "Milling fresh flour is just like grinding fresh coffee beans or spices. The flour we use gives a very flavourful, digestible and highly nutritious bread," says Robertson. Expect a minimum 30-minutes line for the fresh, deeply burnished loaves, with a crackling crust that give way to some of the springiest, most flavourful bread. At The Orange Bakery in England, the father and daughter duo Alex and Kitty Tait bake a bread with wild garlic foraged from the forest. One of their most popular bread is made using miso the Japanese fermented soyabean paste.

When one thinks of sourdough in India, it's hard not to think of Aditi Handa, who




introduced Mumbai to the four-grain sourdough way back in 2013. The chewy, textured bread with a distinctive sour note and a strong crust was way tastier than the sliced-white version that turned into sticky cement in the mouth. She went to unleash the cranberry sourdough and walnut raisin bread.

In India artisanal breads and bakeries are popping up everywhere. Raising the craft to an art form, though, is Masque founder Aditi Dugar's TwentySeven Bakehouse. The bread that will stop you in your tracks is the notoriously esoteric Chilli Cheese Toast and the crusty sourdough infused with cheddar, Bhavnagri chilli and caramelised onion. The aroma, texture, and flavour is remarkable: It's like you've been eating bread in black and white and someone's just turned on the colour.



